2. The Chief Election Commissioner or an Election Commissioner nominated by the Chief Election Commissioner was an ex-officio member

3. The State Election Commissioner of concerned State or Union Territory was the other ex-officio member

Additionally, the Commission had ten associate members in respect of each state. Out of them, five were members of the Lok Sabha elected from that state and another five were members of the State Legislative Assembly. Where the number of members of the Lok Sabha in a state was less than five, all such members were the associate members for that state. These associated members were nominated by the Speakers of the Lok Sabha and State Legislative Assemblies concerned. However, these associated members did not have the right to vote or to sign any order of the Commission.

Justice Kuldip Singh, a retired judge of the Supreme Court, was appointed as the Chairperson of the Commission.

Implementation Of The Recommendations

The Commission submitted its recommendations to the Government in 2007. The President of India signed the notification for implementing the recommendations of the Commission in 2008, thereby redefining Parliamentary and Assembly Constituencies.

The recommendations of the Commission are not applicable to five states, i.e. Assam, Arunachal Pradesh, Manipur, Nagaland and Jharkhand. The Government of India deferred the delimitation exercise in the four north-eastern states and nullified the final order of the Commission for the state of Jharkhand.

The 2009 General Elections to the Lok Sabha for 499 out of 543 Parliamentary constituencies in all the states, National Capital Territory of Delhi and Union Territory of Puducherry (except Assam, Arunachal Pradesh, Manipur, Nagaland, Jharkhand and erstwhile Jammu and Kashmir) were held on the basis of the newly delimited constituencies.

Delimitation Commission (2020)

In February 2020[8], the Government of India rescinded its earlier (2008) notifications which had deferred the delimitation exercise in the four north-eastern states of Assam, Arunachal Pradesh, Manipur and Nagaland on the grounds of a likely threat to the unity and integrity of India as well as a serious threat to the peace and public order in these states. The Government had said that there was a significant improvement in the security situation in these states. Further, there was also reduction in insurgency incidents and improvement in law and order of these states making the situation conducive for carrying out the delimitation exercise. Therefore, it appeared that the circumstances` that led to the deferring of the delimitation exercised in these states have ceased to exist and that the delimitation of the constituencies as envisaged under the Delimitation Act, 2002 could be carried out now.

Subsequently, in March 2020[9], the Government of India set-up a Delimitation Commission for the purpose of delimitation of Parliamentary and Assembly constituencies in these four north-eastern states and the Union Territory of Jammu and Kashmir (UT of J&K). This Commission consisted of the following members:

1. Justice Ranjana Prakash Desai, a retired judge of the Supreme Court, as the Chairperson.